

# Podcast or Perish

## Long-Form Conversations as the New Red Carpet

A CONCEPTUAL FRAMEWORK FOR FILM MARKETING IN THE ATTENTION ECONOMY



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# The Shift from Visibility to Intimacy

## The Old World



### Diffuse Visibility (Trailers)

## The New World



### Concrete Intimacy (Long-Form)

## The Problem

Attention is the scarcest resource. A 2-minute trailer creates awareness, but lacks the depth to convert passive interest into active commitment.

## The Shift

Podcast hosts are the new 'de facto distributors' (Sullivan, 2019). They control the pre-distribution channels that determine cultural relevance.

## The Thesis

Long-form conversations are not just PR stops. They are strategic investments where audiences **'opt-in'** to a relationship with the film.



# The Industry Pivot: Commercials to World-Building

## Literature Review Part I: Strategic Implementation



### Netflix & Brand Equity

The 'Know-It-All' podcast utilizes audio deep dives to supplement viewing.

**Strategy: Brand building through audio paratexts**

(Amanzholova, 2024).



### HBO & The Rewatch

'Band of Brothers' podcast acts as a post-production strategy.

**Strategy: Celebrating original text to enhance long-term brand equity**

(Salvati & Bullinger, 2025).



### Marvel & Intermediality

'Wolverine: The Long Night' expands the cinematic universe.

**Strategy: Podcasts as tools for franchise management and world-building**

(Barker, 2021).



### Spotify & Colonization

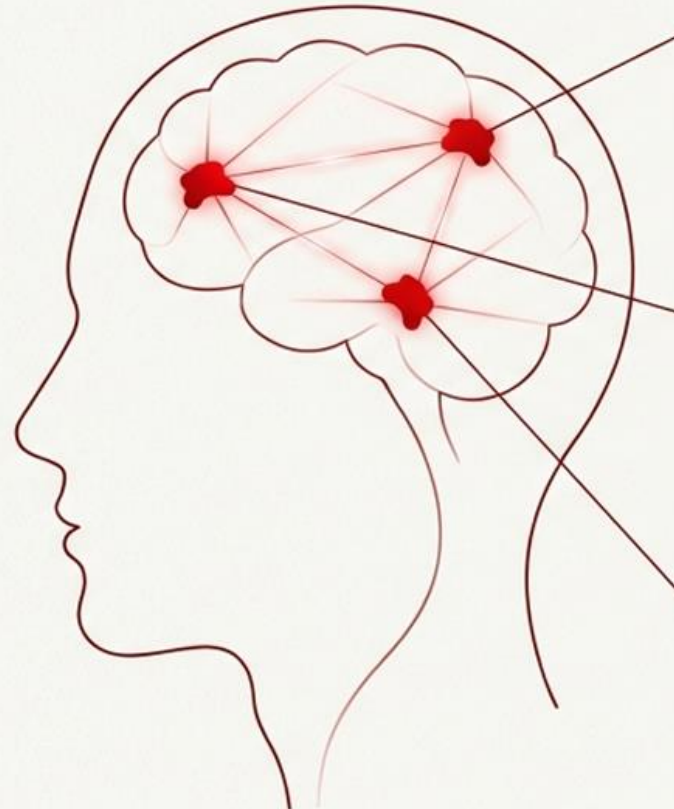
Shift from music distributor to 'audio-first' entertainment.

**Strategy: The colonization of the online audio space for general entertainment**

(Kiberg & Spilker, 2023).

# The Mechanics of Digital Connection

## Literature Review Part II: Psychological Underpinnings



### Parasocial Interaction (PSI)

Audiences form one-sided, emotionally meaningful bonds through repeated exposure. Recurring mediated contact increases perceived intimacy and trust, mimicking real-world friendship.

### Source Credibility Theory

Long-form formats drive 'perceived authenticity.' The unscripted nature of a podcast builds higher trustworthiness than a scripted press junket, directly influencing opinion change.

### Uses-and-Gratifications (UGT)

Audiences are active selectors, not passive vessels. They prioritize podcast conversations to satisfy specific needs: Information, Entertainment, Companionship, and Identity Work.



# The Missing Link in the Conversion Funnel

## Research Problematization



### Diffuse Visibility

Current literature focuses on short-form viral content and awareness.



**The Gap:** How does a 60+ minute conversation convert into a sale? We lack a process-based model to analyze the flow from high-attention listening to downstream behavior.



### Concrete Decision

The ultimate behavioral outcome: Ticket purchase or stream start.

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**Objective:** To propose a framework analyzing the flow from initial exposure to behavioral outcomes in the Global and Indian context.

# Constructing the Framework

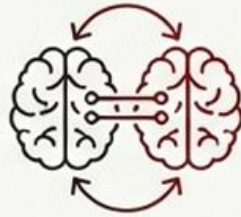
## Methodology & Approach

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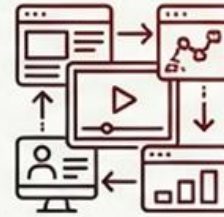
### Marketing Theory

ADO Framework  
(Pushparaj &  
Kushwaha, 2024)



### Psychology

Parasocial Interaction  
& Attachment Theory



### Media Studies

Platform Affordances  
& Algorithms

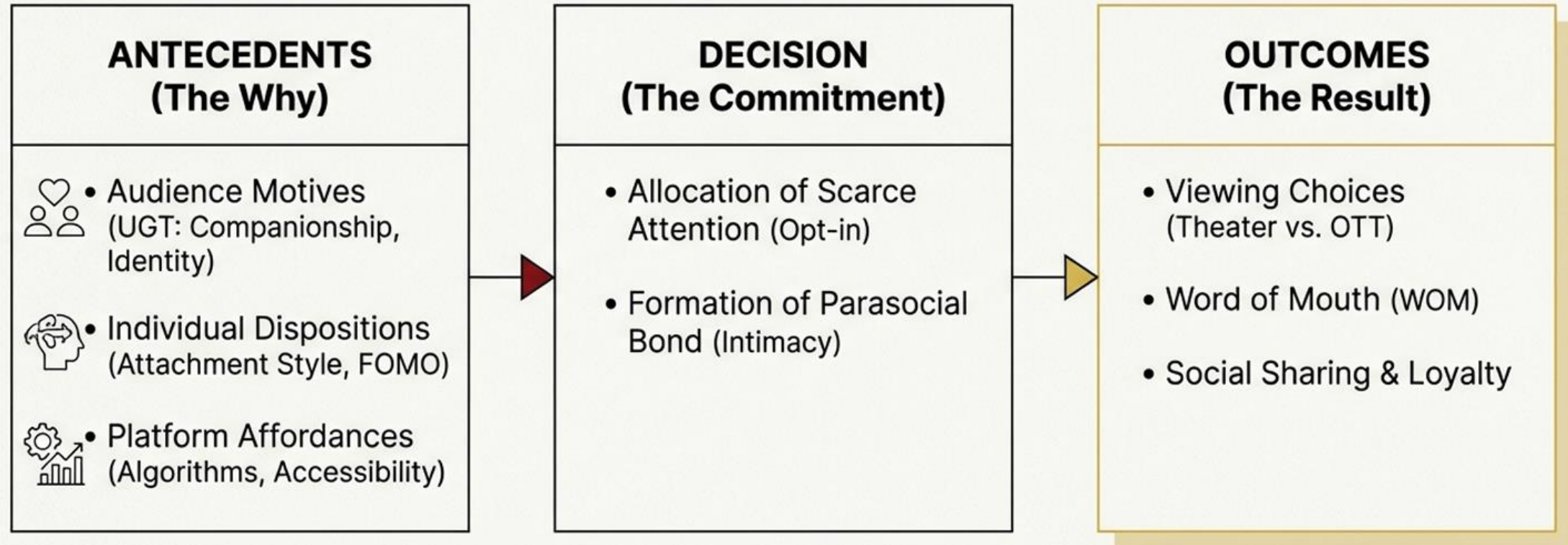


### The Film Distribution ADO Model

A conceptual model specifically applied to the Indian Attention Economy and global film marketing dynamics.



# The ADO Model: Antecedents, Decision, Outcomes



Key Insight: Attention allocation is treated as a strategic decision under scarcity, not passive exposure.

# Converting Curiosity into Commitment

Results: Antecedents & Decisions

## Input: Why They Click



- **Platform Affordances:** Discovery is structured by "recommendation layers" and algorithms.
- **Motives:** Listeners seek "companionship" (ambient listening) and "identity work" (taste performance).

## Process: Why They Stay



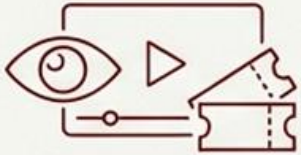
- **Strategic Choice:** Listening is a high-commitment act (60+ mins). Users actively "opt-in" to the narrative.
- **The Mechanism:** Parasocial Interaction. The "conversion rate" depends on the intensity of the relationship-like feelings developed during the episode.



# From Passive Listening to Active Behavior

## Results: Outcomes

### VIEWING INTENTION



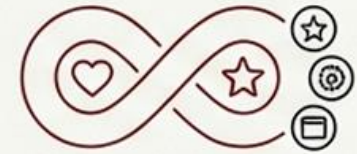
Long-form talk reduces uncertainty ("is this for me?"). It lowers decision friction, influencing timing (opening weekend vs. later) and venue (theater vs. OTT).

### SOCIAL CURRENCY



Long-form episodes are 'clippable' assets. They generate downstream content for TikTok/Reels, fueling Word of Mouth (WOM) and social sharing.

### LOYALTY LOOP



Repeated mediated encounters reinforce identification. Loyalty extends beyond the specific film to the star, the genre, and the hosting platform.



# The New Premiere: Case Studies in Attention

## Discussion

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**Hollywood:** 'Hot Ones'. The new premiere. Substituting quick junkets with personality-revealing endurance tests.



**Bollywood:** 'Film Companion' & 'Koffee with Karan'. Talk-format amplifiers. Event-ized conversations that sustain engagement (Qureshi, 2026).

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**Evolution:** The companion podcast is the modern 'DVD Extra'—sanctioned paratextual content that expands the narrative (Salvati & Bullinger, 2025).



# Strategic Imperatives for the Industry



## **For Marketers: Prioritize Share of Ear**

Treat podcast appearances as high-priority distribution channels, not just PR stops. The intimacy of audio drives the 'share of wallet'.



## **For Platforms: Build Discovery Layers**

Invest in algorithmic surfacing to connect long-form conversations with specific superfan cohorts.

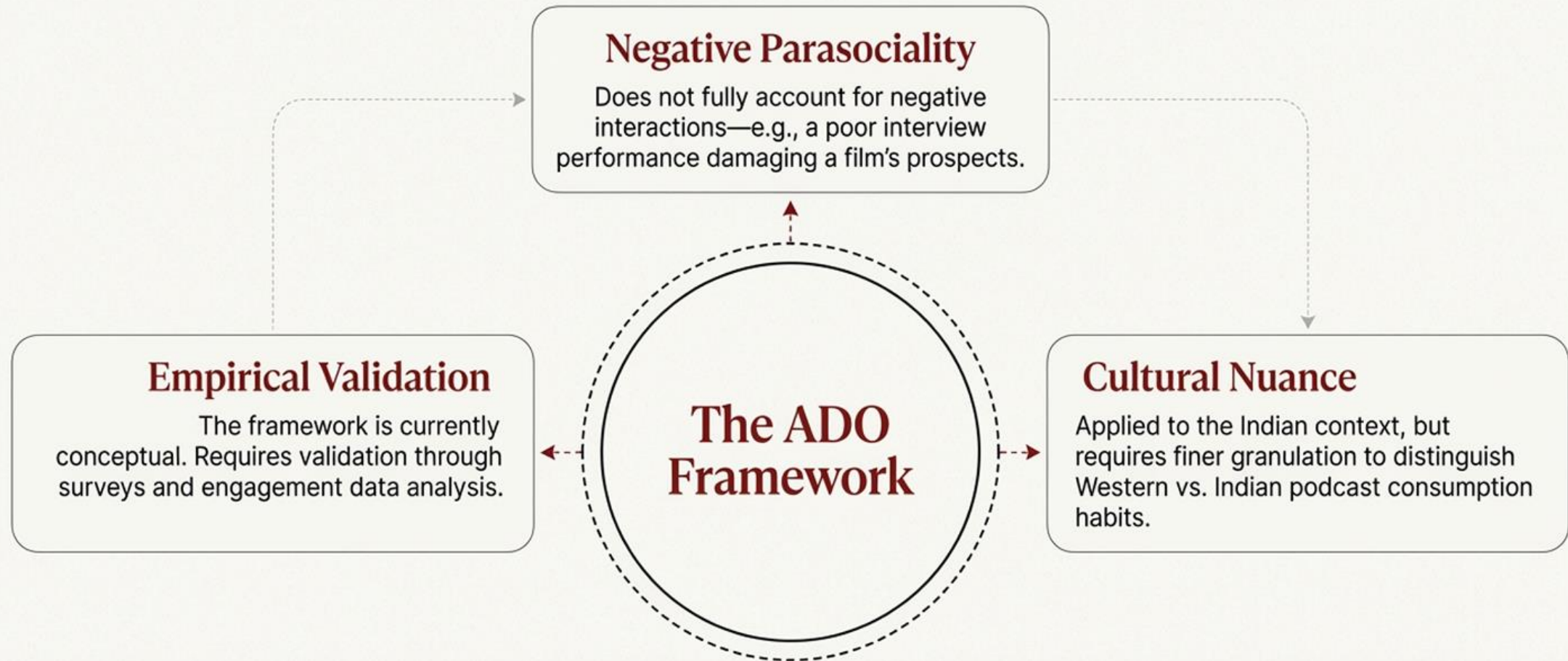


## **For Filmmakers: Control the Narrative**

Use podcasts for pre-release 'world-building.' Leverage the authenticity of the medium to build Source Credibility.

# Boundaries of the Current Model

## Limitations





# The Roadmap for Future Research

## Empirical Validation



Measuring the 'conversion rate' from podcast listening to ticket purchase via surveys.

## Algorithmic Study



Investigating how Spotify/YouTube prioritize long-form interviews over trailers (Kiberg & Spilker, 2023).

## Cross-Media Analysis



Studying the 'feedback loop' where podcasts become source material for films, reversing the flow (Barker, 2021).

# The Infrastructure of Trust

## Conclusion



Podcast hosts have moved from the periphery to the center of film marketing. They are the machinery that converts 'visibility' into 'trust'.

**In the attention economy, the Red Carpet is no longer a physical space—it is a digital frequency.**



Thanks for your time



AI-Assisted Multilingual Podcast

Hindi 00:00:00  
English 00:13:43  
Bengali 00:27:02

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